

Flemish HBM Studies – User Guide

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User Guide

This user guide describes how to request and use Flemish HBM Data in a correct and responsible way.

You can navigate to detailed guidance for:

Data Users - Receiving Data Controllers

Overview

This section describes how to get access to biobanked samples and/or data of the **Flemish HBM studies**.

It focuses on:

- Submission of a **Sample and/or Data request**
-

Legal and ethical framework

Requests may involve **sensitive personal data**, including health data.

All processing must comply with applicable national and EU legal and ethical requirements.

Agreements

to provide context

- Material transfer agreement[LINK to be included]
- Controller agreement[LINK to be included]

Data and/or Sample access request

Access to **biobanked samples** and/or **individual-level data** of the **Flemish HBM studies** is granted on request and subject to approval.

Who can request access?

Sample and/or Data access requests can be submitted by stakeholders for research projects in the public interest, in line with the objectives of the Flemish HBM studies.

Data access procedure

Step-by-step

1. Submits a **Sample and/or Data Access Request Form**
 - Via [Microsoft Forms](#).
 - To prepare for a form submission, you may consult the corresponding word version [\[here\]](#)[to be established].
 - Provide the required annexes via e-mail as instructed in the form.
 - Selection of [studies](#)
 - Selection of [variables](#)
 - Selection of [samples](#)
 2. The request is reviewed by the **Flemish Supervisory Board**
 3. If approved, access is granted:
 - to the requested Flemish HBM biobanked samples
 - to the requested subset of Flemish HBM data (studies and variables),
 - **only after signature of the applicable agreements**
 - Data Controller Agreement[[LINK](#) to be included]
 - Material Transfer Agreement[[LINK](#) to be included]
 4. Approved samples are made available via the Biobank manager
 5. Approved data extracts are made available via the Flemish HBM Data Platform manager (contact)
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Annex – Studies

Download the **Annex – Studies** file(s) [here](#).

For each study you request: - set **request_stud_1isYes = 1**

All studies marked with **request_stud_1isYes = 1** are included in the request.

Annex – Variables

Download the **Annex – Variables** file(s) [here](#)

For each variable you request: - set **request_var_1isYes = 1**

All variables marked with **request_var_1isYes = 1** are included in the request.

Annex – Samples

Download the **Annex – Samples** file(s) [here](#).

For each sample type you request:

- set **request_sample_1isYes = 1**
- fill out: request_sample_volume - indicate the requested minimal volume per sample
- fill out: request_sample_n - indicate the number of requested samples
- fill out: request_sample_remarks - when applicable, provide remarks

All studies marked with **request_sample_1isYes = 1** are included in the request.

Questions?

For questions regarding sample and/or data availability or the request procedure, please contact:
flehs.datamanagement@vito.be